

Friday, 30 January 2026

Floods Displace Khiyelani Family

A Khiyelani family in Bushbuckridge has been left in desperate need of assistance after recent floods that affected parts of Mpumalanga caused extensive damage to their home, leaving it unsafe for habitation.

Ms Beatrice Hlatswayo, a long-time resident of Khiyelani, lives with her children Confidence (14), Cardens (9) and Calvin (46). Their modest two-room house was severely damaged when heavy rainfall led to flooding across several villages in Bushbuckridge, washing away parts of the structure and weakening the walls.

According to residents, the floods struck with little warning, forcing many families to seek temporary shelter with neighbours and relatives. Ms Hlatswayo's home was among those hardest hit, leaving the family exposed to the elements and facing uncertain living conditions.

Ms Hlatswayo is employed as a cooker at Beretta Primary School, earning less than R2 500 per month. Her income is barely sufficient to meet daily household needs, making it impossible for her to afford repairs or to construct a new house without external assistance.

The impact of the floods has been felt widely across Bushbuckridge, with damaged homes, washed-away belongings and disrupted livelihoods reported in several affected areas.

Vulnerable households, particularly those headed by low-income earners, have been left struggling to recover from the disaster.

For the Hlatswayo family, the damage has gone beyond the loss of a home.



Ms Beatrice Hlatswayo, a long-time resident of Khiyelani, lives with her children Confidence (14), Cardens (9) and Calvin (46).

The unsafe structure poses a serious risk, especially to the younger children, and has placed emotional and financial strain on the household.

Community leaders have emphasised the importance of solidarity during times of disaster, calling on residents, businesses, faith-based organisations and humanitarian groups to assist families affected by the floods.

A public appeal is now being made to individuals, organisations and institutions who may be in a position to help with building materials, financial donations or any form of humanitarian support to enable the

family to rebuild and restore safe living conditions.

Any assistance, regardless of size, would go a long way in helping the family regain stability and dignity

following the floods.

Those willing to offer support may contact Ms Beatrice Hlatswayo on 072 039 3218.



CRIME Unlicensed Firearm Suspect Arrested



COMMUNITY Bushbuckridge Mourns Ward 3 Councillor



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SPIRITUAL REBIRTH

Israel Circumcised and Consecrated at Gilgal

Gilgal – Following their miraculous crossing of the Jordan River, the Israelites, under the leadership of Joshua, underwent a profound act of covenant renewal.

The Lord commanded Joshua to circumcise the new generation of Israelite men. The former generation, who had come out of Egypt, had all died in the wilderness due to disobedience. Their sons, born during the 40-year journey, had not been circumcised.

Joshua obeyed, and the procedure was carried out at Gibeath Haaraloth. Afterward, the entire nation remained in camp until the men had healed. The Lord then said to Joshua, “Today I have rolled away

the reproach of Egypt from you,” and the place was named Gilgal, meaning “to roll.”

The Israelites camped at Gilgal, on the plains of Jericho, where they observed the Passover on the evening of the fourteenth day of the month. The very next day, they ate produce from the land — unleavened bread and roasted grain. From that moment, the manna ceased.

On that sacred ground, Joshua encountered a mysterious figure — a man with a drawn sword. When Joshua asked who he was, the man replied, “As commander of the army of the Lord I have now come.” Joshua fell in reverence.

Doctors Strengthen Primary Healthcare Services



The Mpumalanga Department of Health has introduced three full-time medical doctors at community health centres in Bushbuckridge.

The Mpumalanga Department of Health has introduced three full-time medical doctors at community health centres in Bushbuckridge as part of efforts to strengthen primary healthcare services.

On 26 January 2026, the MEC for Health, Ms Sasekani Manzini, visited Hluvukani, Dwarsloop and Oakley Community Health Centres where the newly appointed doctors were officially introduced to staff and community members. Dr G Moripa has been stationed at Hluvukani CHC, Dr E Ngomana at Dwarsloop CHC and Dr NP Nyambi at Oakley CHC.

The strategic placement of doctors at primary healthcare facilities aims to support the implementation of the National Health Insurance (NHI) and advance universal health coverage. This initiative seeks to ensure that communities have improved and



consistent access to quality primary healthcare services close to where they live.

The department highlighted that strengthening primary healthcare is key to improving life expectancy, enhancing clinical governance and raising the quality of care at the first point of contact. The presence of doctors at clinics is also expected to reduce unnecessary referrals and self-referrals to hospitals, while improving early diagnosis, timely treatment and continuity of care.

During her engagement, the MEC urged community members to support and respect the doctors, emphasising the importance of building strong, trust-based relationships between patients and healthcare professionals. Such relationships, she noted, are vital for better health outcomes, increased patient

satisfaction and improved adherence to treatment.

The MEC also encouraged residents who have tested HIV-negative to access lenacapavir, which will be rolled out as part of HIV prevention efforts. Community members were further urged to regularly check their health status for early diagnosis and treatment, and those who have tested positive for TB or HIV were encouraged to return to health facilities to collect their treatment.

Community members who attended the events welcomed the initiative, expressing appreciation for the deployment of full-time doctors at local clinics. They noted that the move will reduce the need for long and costly trips to hospitals, allowing residents to receive timely medical care within their own communities.



CRIME

Unlicensed Firearm Suspect Arrested



Police in Bushbuckridge have arrested a 43-year-old man for possession of an unlicensed firearm and ammunition following a public disturbance along the R40 road in Dwarsloop.

According to a media statement issued by the Office of the Provincial Commissioner in Mpumalanga, the incident occurred on 26 January 2026 when groups of community members blocked the R40 at Dwarsloop, GA Beretta and GA Relane. The group allegedly forced truck drivers to park across the road, blocking access, and confiscated vehicle keys.

Police were dispatched to the scene, where they engaged with the group and monitored the situation. While on duty, officers received information about another group disrupting traffic at a stop-and-go section on an uphill stretch of the road. Members responded swiftly and dispersed the group from the roadway.

During the operation, police observed one suspect carrying a firearm. The man was arrested after failing to produce a valid firearm licence. A firearm with its serial number filed off, along with 12 live rounds of ammunition, was confiscated.

The suspect, identified as Steven Ndobela (43), appeared before the Bushbuckridge Magistrate’s Court on Tuesday, 27 January 2026, facing charges of possession of an unlicensed firearm and ammunition. He remained in custody and is expected to reappear in court on 2 February 2026 for a possible bail application.

The Acting Provincial Commissioner of the SAPS in Mpumalanga, Major General (Dr) Zeph Mkhwanazi, commended the police officers for their swift and professional response.

“The arrest sends a strong message that the SAPS will not tolerate lawlessness, illegal possession of firearms, or actions that threaten public safety. We urge communities to raise their concerns through lawful channels and work with the police to ensure peace and stability,” he said.

Department Denies E-Learning Procurement Claims



The Mpumalanga Department of Education has strongly refuted allegations of wastage and irregular procurement relating to its e-learning devices programme, following reports published by City Press and News24.

In a statement issued on 26 January 2026, the Department said the claims misrepresent the facts surrounding the Ubuhlebusile E-Learning Programme, which was introduced in 2022 as a phased and strategic intervention to improve teaching and

learning across the province.

According to the Department, 64 000 tablets were procured in 2022 for Grade 12 learners under a three-year SITA-facilitated contract valued at R224 million, which included a three-year warranty. Bongani Rainmaker Limited (BRL) was appointed as the supplier in full compliance with government procurement regulations.

In 2025, these devices were replaced with 60 000 Packard Bell tablets at a cost of

R232 million, also inclusive of a three-year warranty. The Department confirmed that the tablets were successfully distributed to Grade 12 learners in quintile 1 to 3 schools and stated that it has received no verified reports of widespread device failure.

The Department further attributed the improvement in Grade 12 results — from 79% in 2023 to 86.55% in 2025 — partly to the effective use of e-learning tools introduced through the programme.

It rejected claims that the Packard Bell tablets constituted wastage, explaining that the devices issued to the 2025 Grade 12 cohort have been retrieved, reformatted and reloaded with updated content. They will be re-issued to the 2026 Grade 12 learners as part of a cost-efficient and sustainable approach.

Looking ahead, the Department confirmed that it has placed an order for 70 000 Windows-based tablet notebooks for Grade 10 learners in 2026, at a cost of R330 million — not R600 million as alleged.

These devices will be retained by learners

from Grade 10 through to Grade 12, with content updated remotely to reduce future logistics and redistribution costs.

The procurement process, facilitated through BRL, allows the service provider to source Department-approved devices, load educational content and manage distribution. Funding is drawn from a dedicated e-learning budget, supplemented by the Learning and Teaching Support Material (LTSM) allocation.

For the 2025/26 financial year, the Department allocated R717 million to the e-learning programme, covering both Grade 10 and Grade 12 learners.

The Department reiterated that all procurement processes were lawful, strategic and focused on improving learner outcomes, adding that allegations of inflated costs, wastage or non-functional devices are misleading and incorrect.

It reaffirmed its commitment to transparency, accountability and the effective use of technology to advance quality education throughout Mpumalanga.

Community Unity Drives Home Affairs Outreach

A Home Affairs outreach programme held at Alexandria Sports Ground in Ward 05 on 26 and 27 January 2026 demonstrated strong community unity and resilience in the face of challenges.

Operations on the first day were disrupted by network connectivity problems, limiting service delivery from the morning until early afternoon. On the second day, further difficulties arose when one of the Home Affairs mobile trucks became stuck due to muddy ground conditions.

Attempts to free the vehicle using a TLB were unsuccessful, prompting a request for additional assistance. With the support of Moshe Thobela, who provided an excavator, the situation was eventually resolved, allowing



services to continue. The second truck only became operational at around 1pm.

Despite these setbacks, cooperation between officials, community members and local leadership ensured progress. A total of 97 people were assisted over the two days, including school learners who required documentation.

Home Affairs officials were commended for their dedication, compassion and willingness to extend working hours to accommodate learners and other residents.

The outreach served as a reminder that, even under difficult circumstances, unity and teamwork can help communities overcome obstacles and ensure essential services reach those in need.



Two Arrested Over Illegal Firearm



Two men have been arrested by police in Acornhoek following the recovery of an unlicensed firearm in the Timbavati Trust area.

The arrests were made on Monday, 26 January 2026, after police received a tip-off about a suspect allegedly in possession of an illegal firearm. Officers conducting patrols in the area spotted a man matching the description provided.

During further investigation, the suspect led police to a parked taxi. A search of the vehicle resulted in the discovery and confiscation of a firearm. The taxi driver was also arrested in connection with the incident.

The two suspects, aged 29 and 36, were charged with possession of an unlicensed firearm and appeared before the Acornhoek Magistrate's Court on Tuesday, 27 January 2026. One suspect, Mfumo Ndlovu (29), was granted bail of R1,000, while Pule Khumbulani Ndlovu (36) was denied bail. Both are expected to reappear in the same court on 3 February 2026 for a possible bail application.

The Acting Provincial Commissioner of the SAPS in Mpumalanga, Major General (Dr) Zeph Mkhwanazi, welcomed the arrests and praised officers for their swift response.

“The recovery of illegal firearms remains a priority for the SAPS, as these weapons are often used to commit serious and violent crimes.

We urge members of the public to continue working with the police by reporting criminal activities,” he said.

Dwarsloop Mall Clarifies Safety Concerns

Dwarsloop Mall has released an official statement to address growing public concern about safety at the shopping centre, following widespread discussion on social media, particularly Facebook.

In recent days, several posts have circulated alleging incidents of robbery, especially around the mall’s public ablution facilities. However, mall management has clarified that some of the reported incidents were cases of scamming rather than armed or forceful robbery.

The statement explains that while robbery involves force or threats, scams rely on deception, with victims voluntarily handing over money or belongings after being misled.

The mall emphasised that both crimes are serious, but are handled through different investigative processes. Management said it is working closely with its security service provider and relevant authorities to investigate all reported incidents.

According to the statement, a breakthrough occurred earlier this week when a vigilant young woman reported suspicious behaviour promptly.

Her action enabled security personnel to respond quickly, leading to the identification and apprehension of a suspect, who was handed over to the authorities for further investigation.



Despite the clarification, community reaction on Facebook has been mixed. Some residents welcomed the mall’s response and praised the role of security, saying the statement helped clear confusion and reduce panic.

Others, however, expressed ongoing fear, with several shoppers saying they now avoid using public toilets alone or prefer visiting the mall only during peak hours.

A number of social media users also called for visible security patrols, better lighting, and clearer communication from management whenever incidents occur.

Some residents argued that, regardless of whether incidents are classified as scams or robberies, shoppers still feel unsafe and want stronger preventative measures.

Dwarsloop Mall has encouraged all shoppers to report suspicious activity immediately to mall security and to open cases with SAPS where necessary. Management reiterated its commitment to maintaining a safe and welcoming environment for the Bushbuckridge community.

As discussions continue online, the situation highlights the importance of accurate information, swift reporting, and cooperation between the public, security services and authorities in addressing crime concerns.

Kruger Gates Reopen As Safety Checks



Some gates and facilities in the Kruger National Park (KNP) have started reopening as safety assessments continue following improved weather conditions across parts of Limpopo and Mpumalanga.

SANParks confirmed that overnight visitors are now permitted to enter the park through Phalaborwa Gate from Monday, 26 January 2026, and through Phabeni Gate from Tuesday, 27 January 2026. Guests using these access points will travel via the S3 and S4 routes to connect with Pretoriuskop and Skukuza.

Further reopening is planned across accommodation facilities and shops in the northern section of the park. Bateleur Bush Camp is set to reopen on Wednesday, 28 January 2026.

The northern shops will reopen in phases, with Punda Maria shop already reopened on 26 January, while Shingwedzi and Mopani shops are expected to reopen on 28 January. The Letaba shop is scheduled to reopen on 30 January 2026.

SANParks also announced that Mopani Rest Camp is due to reopen on Friday, 30 January 2026, although the restaurant and

swimming pool will remain closed. However, Letaba and Shingwedzi Rest Camps, including the Pafuri Border Post, remain inaccessible and closed until further notice.

In the Marula Region, SANParks said Biyamiti and Talamati Bush Camps remain closed, while Satara Rest Camp and N’wanetsi Picnic Spot are open. Orpen Gate remains inaccessible to general visitors and may only be used by overnight guests, emergency services and essential deliveries.

SANParks also issued a caution to travellers heading towards Orpen, advising them to remain alert on the R40 near Dwarsloop, where there have been reports of protests.

Visitors have been strongly urged not to remove barricades or attempt to access closed roads, as restrictions are in place to protect visitors and allow continued infrastructure assessment and recovery work. SANParks confirmed that gravel roads remain closed until further notice, and access restrictions will be reviewed as conditions improve and repairs progress.

WHO WILL MAKE THE CUT?

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Bushbuckridge Mourns Ward 3 Councillor

The Bushbuckridge community is in mourning following the passing of Councillor and ANC Branch Secretary for Ward 3, Comrade Mohammed Male, on 28 January 2026 after a brief illness.

Cde Male served his community with dedication, integrity and compassion, holding both the role of Branch Secretary and Ward Councillor in the Bushbuckridge Local Municipality. Known for his calm nature and humility, he earned the respect of colleagues and residents alike, leaving a lasting legacy through his leadership and commitment to public service.

The ANC in Ehlanzeni Region expressed its shock and sorrow, extending heartfelt condolences to his family, friends and comrades. “An uncompromised member of

the movement of the people, Cde Male served with diligence and left a meaningful mark on the community,” the party said.

Residents and colleagues have shared tributes online, remembering Cde Male as a devoted family man, a man of faith, and a leader who treated everyone with dignity. “His calm nature, kindness and willingness to serve will be remembered by all who worked with him,” one community member posted on social media. Many highlighted the positive impact he made in Ward 3 despite his term being cut short.

The community is encouraged to keep his family and loved ones in their thoughts during this difficult time. Councillor Mohammed Male’s service and legacy in Ward 3 will not be forgotten.



Councillor and ANC Branch Secretary for Ward 3, Comrade Mohammed Male.

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Bushbuckridge
1280
Email: info@bushbuckridge.gov.za
Website: www.bushbuckridge.gov.za

PUBLIC NOTICE

TO : THE PUBLIC
SUBJECT : WATER SUPPLY INTERRUPTION
DATE : 27 JANUARY 2026
REF : 10/2/1/1

The communities of Mapulaneng Hospital, Bushbuckridge CBD, College View, Mphenyatsatsi, Forest, and surrounding areas are hereby notified of water supply interruptions due to a burst pipe at Mphenyatsatsi; the pipeline is isolated for the duration of the breakdown and normal water supply will be restored back to normal once the burst pipe has been attended.

The municipality apologizes for the inconvenience the situation has caused.

Social Media handles
Twitter : @Bbr municipality
Facebook : Bushbuckridge Municipality

ISSUED BY THE MUNICIPAL MANAGER
BLM COMMUNICATIONS
NOTICE NUMBER: 27/01/2026/84



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Bushbuckridge
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PUBLIC NOTICE

TO : THE PUBLIC
SUBJECT : WATER SUPPLY INTERRUPTION
DATE : 26 JANUARY 2026
REF : 10/2/1/1

Kindly be informed that water supply has been interrupted due to burst pipe at Saselani, the pipe burst has affected the communities of Dwarsloop Civic Centre, Dwarsloop Phase 1 & 2, and Saselani. Normal water supply will be restored back to normal once the burst pipe has been attended.

The municipality apologizes for the inconvenience the situation has caused.

Social Media handles
Twitter : @Bbr municipality
Facebook : Bushbuckridge Municipality

ISSUED BY THE MUNICIPAL MANAGER
BLM COMMUNICATIONS
NOTICE NUMBER: 26/01/2026/83





VACANCIES

INTERNSHIP PROGRAMME 2026/27

The Mpumalanga Provincial Treasury offers a two-year Internship programme for unemployed graduates residing within the Province in the following fields of study for the 2026/27 financial year.

Criteria:

To qualify for the internship programme, you must:

- Be an unemployed graduate aged between 18 to 35 years.
- Have completed a three (03) year National / Advanced Diploma / Degree/ Honours / Master's degree in the under-mentioned fields of study from accredited Higher Education and Training institutions.
- Be a South African Citizen.
- Have not previously participated in an internship programme.

Stipend:

Interns shall be paid a stipend allowance as per the Ministerial Determination of Interns in the Public Service as follows: **R 94 326.00 per annum**

Directorate / Division	No	Field of Study	Station and Ref No.
Communication	1	Media Studies / Communication / Public Relations	Head Office – MPT01/INT/2026
Legal Services	1	Law	Head Office – MPT02/INT/2026
Planning	1	Public Administration /Public Affairs / Public Management / Monitoring and Evaluation	Head Office – MPT03/INT/2026
Internal Audit	1	Internal Auditing	Head Office – MPT04/INT/2026
Security Management	1	Security Management	Head Office – MPT05/INT/2026
Human Resource Administration /Development	2	Human Resource Management / Development	Head Office – MPT06/INT/2026
Office of the CFO	4	Supply Chain / Logistics Management	Head Office – MPT07/INT/2026
Office of the CFO	4	Accounting/Financial Management	Head Office – MPT08/INT/2026
PAFD	2	Accounting/Financial Management/Banking	Head Office – MPT09/INT/2026
Budget & Expenditure Management	2	Economics/Public Finance/Accounting/Statistical Analysis/Data Analysis	Head Office – MPT10/INT/2026
Municipal Finance	2	Accounting/Financial Management	Gert Sibande District – MPT11/INT/2026
Municipal Finance	2	Accounting/Financial Management	Ehlanzeni Region – MPT12/INT/2026
Municipal Finance	2	Accounting/Financial Management	Nkangala Region – MPT13/INT/2026
Information Technology	1	Information Technology/Computer Science	Gert Sibande Region – MPT14/INT/2026
Information Technology	1	Information Technology/Computer Science	Nkangala Region – MPT15/INT/2026
Information Technology	3	Information Technology/Computer Science	Head Office – MPT16/INT/2026
Provincial Supply Chain Management	3	Supply Chain Management/Logistics/Public Procurement	Head Office – MPT17/INT/2026
Accounting Services	2	Accounting/Financial Management	Head Office – MPT18/INT/2026
Risk Management	1	Risk Management	Head Office - MPT19/INT/2026

DIRECTION FOR APPLICATIONS:

- Applications must be sent through the e-recruitment portal: <https://erecruitment.mpg.gov.za>.
- Applicants must register/create a profile on the provincial e-recruitment portal before applying. Please **upload** all required documents.
- Only shortlisted candidates will be requested to submit certified copies of their qualifications and ID, and a copy of proof of residence obtained from your local municipality or Tribal Authority, which is no **older than 6 months** on the day of the interview.

PLEASE NOTE THE FOLLOWING:

- The Mpumalanga Provincial Treasury is an equal opportunity, affirmative action Employer. The Provincial Treasury intends to promote retrospectivity in terms of (race, gender, and disability) through filling these posts, and all appointments will be made in accordance with the Employment Equity targets of the Provincial Treasury.
- Suitably qualified women and persons with disabilities remain the targeted group and are encouraged to apply.
- All appointments will be subjected to a personnel suitability check process, not limited to the following: - (criminal record, credit record, qualification verification, citizenship, employment reference, and social media).
- It is the applicant's responsibility to have foreign qualifications evaluated by the South African Qualifications Authority (SAQA).
- Successful candidates will be required to enter into a performance agreement.
- Shortlisted candidates may be required to undergo skills assessment where necessary.
- Applications received after the closing date or those that do not comply with the requirements indicated above will not be considered.
- If you have not been contacted within three (3) months of the closing date of this advertisement, please accept that your application was unsuccessful.
- However, should there be any dissatisfaction, applicants are hereby advised to, within 90 days, seek reasons for the above administrative action in terms of section 5 of the Promotion of Administrative Justice, 2000 (Act No. 3 of 2000).
- Full details of advertised posts are placed on the Mpumalanga Provincial Treasury website: <https://treasury.mpg.gov.za> and Facebook account @Mpumalanga Treasury
- The Provincial Treasury reserves the right not to make any appointment(s) to the advertised posts.

ENQUIRIES

Mr DJ Sibiyi at 013 766 4386/4478, Mr Mpilo Dube at 013 766 4374/4435, Ms Christine Mabandla 013 766 4565/4138

Closing Date: 13 February 2026 at 23H59



Persons with Disabilities are encouraged to apply

SASSA Clarifies SRD Rules, Offers Help



The South African Social Security Agency (SASSA) in Mpumalanga has urged beneficiaries of the R370 Social Relief of Distress (SRD) grant who do not have access to data, smartphones or computers to visit their nearest SASSA local offices for assistance.

In a statement issued on Tuesday, the agency said all SASSA offices are fully equipped to support beneficiaries with biometric identity verification using kiosks, official laptops and free guest Wi-Fi.

Acting Regional Executive Manager Xolela Mpambani said the initiative is aimed at ensuring that qualifying beneficiaries receive their grants on time. “The agency is doing this to avoid unnecessary delays, reduce frustrations and ensure that all eligible beneficiaries are assisted efficiently,” he said.

Mpambani explained that some SRD grant applications are declined when the system detects a source of income through external databases, including financial institutions. Beneficiaries who are unhappy with the outcome of their applications have the right to lodge an appeal through the official system.

SASSA has also cautioned beneficiaries to protect their personal information, warning that scammers often target vulnerable grant recipients. Beneficiaries have been advised not to share sensitive details and to always verify the identity of anyone requesting personal information.

In a separate media statement, SASSA expressed concern over false information circulating on social media claiming that the agency has amended its policies to allow

foreign nationals to access SRD grants as asylum seekers or special permit holders.

SASSA spokesperson Paseka Letsatsi said the information is incorrect and misleading. He confirmed that no policies or regulations relating to the Covid-19 SRD grant have been amended.

“No such changes were announced by the Minister of Finance during the Medium-Term Budget Policy Statement, nor by the Minister of Social Development during her budget vote speech,” Letsatsi said, adding that only the National Treasury and the Department of Social Development can announce policy changes.

SASSA Chief Executive Officer Themba Matlou urged the public not to spread

unverified information. “No regulations or eligibility criteria have changed. Any future changes will be officially announced by the Minister of Social Development and published accordingly,” he said.

The Covid-19 SRD regulations, published in 2022, outline that applicants must be between 18 and 60 years old, reside in South Africa and have insufficient means of support. Applicants must also meet citizenship or permit requirements and be registered on the relevant government databases.

As of 1 January, SASSA had received 14 135 SRD applications from permanent residents, refugees and special permit holders, with 8 368 approved and 2 690 payments processed.

Disaster Planning Gaps Exposed by Floods



The Minister of Human Settlements, Ms Thembi Simelane, has underscored the urgent need for a comprehensive national framework to address climate-induced disasters, warning that poor planning continues to delay relief efforts for affected communities.

Speaking at the Bushbuckridge Local Municipality council chambers in Mpumalanga, Minister Simelane said disaster mitigation initiatives should not be limited to one province but must be rolled out across the country to protect communities and strengthen resilience.

Her remarks followed visits to areas in Limpopo and Mpumalanga affected by

recent flooding caused by prolonged rainfall. The Minister raised concern that emergency interventions, particularly under the human settlements emergency housing programme, are often delayed due to the lack of suitable land for relocating displaced families and inadequate planning.

“We need to start planning collaboratively, plan for our growth, say where we are going and what happens during disasters. We must be proactive and prepare land accordingly with weather reports and projections,” said Simelane.

She stressed that municipalities must prioritise climate-resilient infrastructure to ensure communities are not excluded from

relief efforts.

Mpumalanga MEC for Cooperative Governance, Human Settlements and Traditional Affairs, Mr Sped Mashilo, echoed the Minister’s call for proactive and coordinated planning.

He said the issue of poor planning in human settlements had also been highlighted by President Cyril Ramaphosa during a recent visit to the province.

“We cannot continue to behave as if we do not anticipate disasters, especially when weather forecasters are able to predict

rainfall patterns,” Mashilo said.

Both leaders emphasised the need for cooperation between the three spheres of government and communities to protect vulnerable residents from harsh living conditions caused by climate-related disasters and delayed relief efforts due to unsafe or unsuitable land.

Minister Simelane and MEC Mashilo further agreed to review other human settlements grants allocated to the province, particularly those aimed at rebuilding roads, sewer systems and storm-water drainage infrastructure damaged by flooding.



SPORT

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Friday, 30 January 2026

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Kruger United Open Season With Draw



Kruger United FC kicked off their 2026 campaign with a hard-fought 1–1 draw against Baroka FC at Kanyamazane Stadium on Saturday, 24 January, in front of a lively home crowd enjoying free entry.

The village boys showed early intent in their first game of the year, but found themselves trailing midway through the second half when Baroka took the lead in the 73rd minute. Kruger United responded with tactical changes as Kagiso Malinga was introduced for Kgopotso Zitha in search of renewed attacking momentum.

A decisive moment came late in the match when Ntsako Makhubela was substituted in the 83rd minute, making way for Aphiwe Maphothe. Just a minute later, Maphothe made an instant impact, finding the back of the net in the 84th minute to level the scores



and secure a valuable point for the home side.

The equaliser sparked celebrations among supporters and underlined Kruger United's fighting spirit as they begin their push for a strong season.

Earlier in the day, the club also announced a significant boost to their squad with the signing of Neverdie Ntsako Makhubela as an attacking midfielder. The club expressed confidence that his technical ability and understanding of the game will strengthen their attacking structure and support their ambitions for the season.

Kruger United FC welcomed the new signing and thanked supporters for turning out in numbers, promising an exciting campaign ahead.

An advertisement for the Kruger Panorama Experience. The top half features a collage of images: a large elephant, a safari vehicle with people, and a herd of antelope. The bottom half has a red background with white text. The text reads: 'Your Local Gateway to Nature's Greatest Show. ENJOY THE KRUGER PARK AND ALL ITS BEAUTY'. Below this, there are three contact options: a phone icon with the number 0734901886, an email icon with the address vonixiluvahospitality@gmail.com, and a globe icon with the website www.krugerpanoramaexperience.com. In the top right corner of the advertisement, there is a logo for 'Kruger Panorama Experience' with the tagline 'ENJOY THE KRUGER PARK AND ALL ITS BEAUTY'.